

How to Contribute to Drupal and Reap the Benefits

Drupal is one of the leading content management systems used by government agencies, individuals and enterprises. Contributions to Drupal have played a very important part in the development of this project. These contributions can be in the form of patches to fix issues in existing projects or creating code for new projects.



Drupal is an open source content management platform powering millions of websites and applications. Written in PHP, it is built, used and supported by an active and diverse community of people around the world. It has been used by many websites, ranging from personal blogs to corporate, political and government portals.

The standard release of Drupal is called the Drupal Core. It contains the basic features of content management systems (CMS). It is a simple website, where you can add content and change themes according to your wish.

There are many developers who are actively working in the community. The issues are solved within a very short period of time and the community tries to make Drupal bug-free. Drupal 8 is the latest version, and it recently achieved zero critical issues. This is really a great achievement and becoming a part of this organisation is something special.

Drupal promises lots of opportunities to students. There are frequent Drupal conferences happening around the globe, where you can conduct sessions as a speaker. Drupal is also an active Google Summer of Code organisation. Being a part of this community will definitely benefit you a lot. You can work with a lot of experienced developers and explore many new interesting things. There are many mentors who are ready to help you at any point in time.

Installing Drupal

Ensure that you have installed Git on your system. We will be cloning the Git repository of Drupal.

Also, make sure that you have the LAMP (Linux, Apache, MySQL, PHP) stack installed in your system. LAMP supports Drupal with lots of interesting features, which you can explore. If you have PhpMyadmin installed too, it will be really helpful, especially when working with the database.

Now, move on to installing Drupal. Since we are focusing on the developer approach, let's clone a developer version of Drupal 8. Let's start with the 8.0.X version.

Once you have installed the LAMP stack, I hope you get the `/var/www/html` location. Inside that, create any folder, as follows:

```
mkdir Drupal8
cd Drupal8
So, to start cloning enter
$git clone --branch 8.0.x http://git.Drupal.org/project/
```

This will give you Drupal 8 cloned in your system. Once the cloning is done, we need to start the installation process. Open your browser and go to the location of Drupal. It will most probably be `localhost/Drupal8/Drupal`.

I hope you got something like what's shown in Figure 1.

You are asked to choose the language. Do so, then click on **Save** and **Continue**.

Now, click on **Standard**. This will have all the required basic features of Drupal. You will then be led to the **Drupal Requirements** page. Ensure that you meet all the conditions. If you get a red mark across any of the requirements, fix it before going forward.